MODULE 18 · DOMAIN 2 - PROCESS

Scope in predictive projects

Eliciting requirements, defining scope and its exclusions, building the work breakdown structure, and the difference between validating and controlling scope.

DOMAIN II - Process EXAM WEIGHT 41% MODULE 18 of 49

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Scope is what the project will deliver, and just as importantly, **what it will not**.

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Product scope or project scope?

PRODUCT SCOPE

What is delivered

- Features and functions of the result
- Measured against requirements
- 'The app lets patients reschedule'
- Owned by the customer's needs

PROJECT SCOPE

The work to deliver it

- All work needed to produce the result
- Measured against the plan
- Includes training, testing, migration
- Owned by the project

THE TIEBREAKER

Project scope includes work the customer never sees, such as testing, training and handover. It all counts.

Eliciting requirements

TECHNIQUE	BEST WHEN
Interviews	Individual experts; sensitive or detailed topics
Workshops and focus groups	Several stakeholders must agree, or reconcile differences
Observation, or job shadowing	Users cannot easily describe what they actually do
Questionnaires and surveys	Many people, spread widely, with simple questions
Prototypes	People react better to something they can see and try
Document analysis and benchmarking	Existing systems, rules, contracts, or other organisations' practice

ON THE EXAM

Match the technique to the people. If users cannot describe the work, watch them do it.

Kinds of requirement

TYPE	EXAMPLE
Business	Reduce missed appointments by a quarter
Stakeholder	Reception staff can rebook a patient in under a minute
Functional	The app sends a reminder forty-eight hours before an appointment
Non-functional	Pages load in under two seconds; accessible to screen readers
Transition	Staff are trained before their clinic goes live
Project	Clinic go-lives fall outside flu season

ON THE EXAM

Non-functional and transition requirements are the ones most often missed. Ask about them explicitly.

The requirements traceability matrix

- Links each requirement to its **source**, the **objective** it serves, the **deliverable** that meets it, and the **test** that proves it.
- Shows that every requirement is delivered and tested, and nothing is missed.
- Shows that every deliverable traces to a requirement, which exposes gold plating.
- Makes change impact visible: change a requirement, and see what else it touches.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Need to prove each requirement was delivered and tested? The traceability matrix is the tool.

The project scope statement

- **Product scope description**: what will be created.
- **Deliverables** and their **acceptance criteria**.
- **Exclusions**: what is explicitly out of scope.
- **Assumptions and constraints** that shape the scope.
- Silence is not exclusion. If something might be assumed, write down that it is out.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Exclusions prevent more disputes than any other line in the scope statement.

Building a work breakdown structure

01

Project

The whole of the work.

02

Major deliverables

Or phases, the main building blocks.

03

Sub-deliverables

Broken down until manageable.

04

Work packages

The lowest level: estimated, scheduled, costed, assigned.

ON THE EXAM

A WBS is a hierarchy of deliverables, not a list of activities. Activities come later, in the schedule.

WBS rules the exam uses

- The **100 percent rule**: the WBS includes all the work, and only the work, in scope.
- Each level adds up exactly to the level above. Nothing missing, nothing extra.
- Built **with the team**: the people doing the work know what it involves.
- A **WBS dictionary** describes each work package: scope, acceptance criteria, owner, estimates.
- Work missing from the WBS will be missing from the schedule and the budget too.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> If work is found late that was never planned, the 100 percent rule was broken in the WBS.

The scope baseline

- **Scope statement + WBS + WBS dictionary** = the scope baseline.
- Approved, then changed only through **change control**.
- Together with the schedule and cost baselines, it forms the performance measurement baseline.
- It is what 'in scope' and 'out of scope' are measured against.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Is it in scope? Check the scope baseline. Changing it? Use change control.

Validate scope or control scope?

VALIDATE SCOPE

Formal acceptance

- Customer or sponsor reviews deliverables
- Checks they meet acceptance criteria
- Produces accepted deliverables
- Happens after quality control

CONTROL SCOPE

Managing the boundary

- Monitors scope status throughout
- Compares work to the baseline
- Manages changes through change control
- Prevents scope creep

THE TIEBREAKER

Validate is about acceptance by the customer. Control is about managing changes to the baseline.

From deliverable to acceptance

01

Build

The team produces the deliverable.

›

02

Control quality

The team checks it is correct.

›

03

Validate scope

The customer checks it is acceptable.

›

04

Accepted

Formally signed off, ready for closure.

ON THE EXAM

Quality control first, then validation. Never ask a customer to accept something the team has not checked.

Scope creep and gold plating

- **Scope creep**: uncontrolled additions, often small, often requested directly of team members.
- **Gold plating**: the team adds extras nobody asked for.
- Both are prevented by a clear baseline, a known change process, and team awareness.
- Requests are welcome. They go through change control, where impact is assessed and someone decides.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Small, direct, undocumented additions are scope creep. The fix is the process, not refusing every request.

Getting agreement on scope

- The outline asks you to **obtain stakeholder agreement on project scope**.
- Walk key stakeholders through the scope statement and WBS, especially the exclusions.
- Resolve conflicting requirements before the baseline, not after.
- Obtain formal approval, then share the baseline with everyone who needs it.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Agreement means stakeholders understood the boundaries, not just that someone signed a document.

Project Lantern: part of the WBS

- **1 Hardware**: 1.1 kiosks procured; 1.2 kiosks installed; 1.3 network upgraded.
- **2 Data**: 2.1 data cleansed; 2.2 data migrated; 2.3 migration verified.
- **3 People**: 3.1 staff trained; 3.2 clinic readiness confirmed.
- **4 App**: managed through the product backlog, with release milestones in the WBS.
- Excluded: integration with the regional hospital's system, which is a separate project.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Deliverables, not activities. Hidden work, such as verification and training, included. Exclusions stated.

Scenario signals and the move

THE SCENARIO SAYS	THE MOVE
A deliverable passed quality control	Validate scope: customer acceptance
A stakeholder asked a team member for an extra	Route it through change control
Work discovered late that was never planned	The WBS broke the 100 percent rule
Prove every requirement was delivered and tested	Requirements traceability matrix
Customer assumed something was included	Exclusions should have been stated
Users cannot describe their work	Observation, or job shadowing

ON THE EXAM

Define it, break it down, agree it, then control it and get it accepted.

> On a predictive project, the team has completed the first major deliverable, a new payroll interface. It has passed the team's quality control testing.
>
> The project manager is deciding what should happen next with the deliverable.

What should the project manager do next?

A Close the project phase, since the deliverable is complete.

B Repeat quality control to be certain it is correct.

C Update the WBS to show the work package as complete.

D Review the deliverable with the customer to obtain formal acceptance.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the project manager do next?

A Close the phase.

Skips acceptance. A deliverable is not finished until the customer accepts it.

B Repeat quality control.

Already passed. Repeating it adds nothing.

C Update the WBS.

Housekeeping, and the WBS does not track status in that way.

D Obtain the customer's formal acceptance.

Validate scope comes after quality control.

THE SIGNAL

Quality control passed means ready for validation. Acceptance comes before closure.

> A client's finance manager asked a developer directly for an extra export button on a report screen. The developer added it, since it took only an hour.
>
> The project manager discovers this during a review. The button is not in the scope baseline.

What should the project manager do?

A. Talk to the developer and the finance manager, explain the change process, and assess this request through it.

B. Leave the button in place, since it took only an hour and the client wanted it.

C. Remove the button immediately, since it is out of scope.

D. Formally reprimand the developer for exceeding scope.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the project manager do?

A Explain the process; assess the request through it.

Stops the creep at its source and still treats the request fairly.

B Leave it.

Accepts uncontrolled change. One hour today, a pattern tomorrow.

C Remove it immediately.

Reacts without assessment, and may frustrate the client needlessly.

D Reprimand the developer.

Punishes a helpful instinct. Coaching fixes it; blame does not.

THE SIGNAL

A direct, small, undocumented addition is scope creep. Fix the route, not the person.

> Near the end of a system roll-out, the project manager discovers that nobody planned the training of three hundred end users. It is not in the schedule or the budget.
>
> The training will take four weeks and has no funding.

What should the project manager have done to prevent this?

A Built a more detailed schedule for the roll-out phase.

B Added a larger contingency reserve to the budget.

C Decomposed the full scope with the team and stakeholders, so the WBS included all the work.

D Used fewer levels in the WBS to keep it simple.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the project manager have done to prevent this?

A More detailed schedule.

The schedule comes from the WBS. Missing work stays missing.

B More contingency.

Reserves cover uncertainty, not work that was simply forgotten.

C Full decomposition with team and stakeholders.

The 100 percent rule: all the work in scope, including transition work.

D Fewer WBS levels.

Less decomposition makes missing work more likely, not less.

THE SIGNAL

Work found late that was never planned: the WBS did not contain 100 percent of the scope.

> During a compliance audit, an auditor asks the project manager to show, for each regulatory requirement, which business objective it supports, which deliverable meets it, and which test proved it.
>
> The project has two hundred requirements.

Which project artefact provides this information?

A The issue log

B The requirements traceability matrix

C The WBS dictionary

D The project scope statement

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which project artefact provides this information?

A Issue log

Tracks problems, not requirements.

B Requirements traceability matrix

Links each requirement to objective, deliverable and test.

C WBS dictionary

Describes work packages, not requirement-by-requirement tracing.

D Scope statement

Describes scope and exclusions, not individual traceability.

THE SIGNAL

Requirement to objective to deliverable to test: that chain is the traceability matrix.

A consultancy is building a new customer database for a client. At the final review, the client asks when the old customer records will be transferred.

The scope statement lists the new database and its features. It says nothing about migrating old data.

What should the project manager have done to prevent this?

A Stated data migration as an explicit exclusion, and confirmed the exclusions with the client.

B Offered to migrate the data free of charge.

C Refused the request, since it is not in the scope statement.

D Written a longer contract covering every possible item.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the project manager have done to prevent this?

A Explicit exclusion, confirmed with the client.

Silence let the client assume. A stated, agreed exclusion prevents it.

B Migrate free.

A reaction, not prevention, and uncontrolled scope.

C Refuse.

A reaction, and it damages the relationship.

D A longer contract.

Length does not create shared understanding. One clear exclusion does.

THE SIGNAL

Something a stakeholder could reasonably assume was included must be explicitly excluded.

> A project will redesign a warehouse picking process. In interviews, pickers give vague answers about how they work, and say 'we just know where things are'.
>
> The warehouse is noisy, and pickers are paid by the number of orders they complete.

Which elicitation technique should the business analyst use next?

A. A detailed questionnaire for all pickers.

B. Longer, more structured interviews.

C. Observation, shadowing pickers as they work.

D. Analysis of the existing process documents.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which elicitation technique should the business analyst use next?

A Questionnaire.

Still asks people to describe what they cannot put into words, and costs them paid time.

B Longer interviews.

More of the technique that is already producing vague answers.

C Observation.

Captures the real process, tacit knowledge included, without stopping work.

D Process documents.

Useful context, but 'we just know' suggests practice differs from documents.

THE SIGNAL

When people cannot describe their work, watch them do it.

Define it, exclude clearly, break it down fully, then **control and accept** it.